

Levie v. Stewart

Aerospace manufacturing operations and acquisition-company industrial know-how involving VAERO, VECCO Aerospace Group and a portfolio that publicly includes aerospace and titanium/superalloy manufacturing facilities.

Independent preliminary research based on public information.

FILED	FORUM	DOCKET	MATTER
2026-08-18	D. Wyo.	2:26-cv-00240	Trade Secret

Prepared 2026-08-25. No attorney or expert contacted. Availability, interest, compensation, and conflicts not checked.

Public filing, likely recipient, and technical frame

CAPTION	Levie et al. v. Stewart et al.
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FORUM / DOCKET	D. Wyo. / 2:26-cv-00240
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FILED / TYPE	2026-08-18 / trade secret
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PUBLIC DOCKET	Open docket
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VERIFIED PUBLIC RECORD

Levie et al. v. Stewart et al., No. 2:26-cv-00240, filed 2026-08-18 in D. Wyo..

LIKELY RESEARCH PURCHASER

Lucas Evan Buckley - Hathaway & Kunz, LLP; named matter counsel. Buckley is the sole counsel identified for the plaintiffs and filed the complaint and preliminary-injunction papers on filing day.

lbuckley@hkwyolaw.com - publicly listed on the [official firm biography](#); not inferred.

TECHNICAL FRAME

Aerospace manufacturing operations and acquisition-company industrial know-how involving VAERO, VECCO Aerospace Group and a portfolio that publicly includes aerospace and titanium/superalloy manufacturing facilities.

Secondary-source limitation: This is a preliminary technical frame based on public sources. Filed pleadings, claim charts, discovery, source code, product versions, and admissible evidence must control. [Open public synopsis](#)

Questions likely to require expert input

This issue map is a research plan, not a legal conclusion. The filed complaint, patent exhibits, intrinsic record, and discovery must control.

01 What aerospace-facility processes, titanium/superalloy recipes, qualification data, costing, customer requirements, or acquisition know-how are allegedly secret?

What aerospace-facility processes, titanium/superalloy recipes, qualification data, costing, customer requirements, or acquisition know-how are allegedly secret?

Potential evidence: Pleadings and claim charts; source code or engineering records; product and version documentation; standards and prior art; reproducible testing; and fact or technical testimony as applicable.

02 Which manufacturing steps and controls materially affect microstructure, defects, fatigue, yield, and aerospace certification?

Which manufacturing steps and controls materially affect microstructure, defects, fatigue, yield, and aerospace certification?

Potential evidence: Pleadings and claim charts; source code or engineering records; product and version documentation; standards and prior art; reproducible testing; and fact or technical testimony as applicable.

03 Were the disputed practices generally known, independently developed, or ascertainable from standards, audits, equipment vendors, and public facility information?

Were the disputed practices generally known, independently developed, or ascertainable from standards, audits, equipment vendors, and public facility information?

Potential evidence: Pleadings and claim charts; source code or engineering records; product and version documentation; standards and prior art; reproducible testing; and fact or technical testimony as applicable.

Questions likely to require expert input

Candidates 1-2 for further diligence

Ranked for preliminary research priority based on subject-matter fit, relevant public work, testimony, and visible diligence burden. This is not a retention recommendation.

01 Aijun Huang

Professor and director, Monash Centre for Additive Manufacturing

TECHNICAL FIT

Exceptional fit for titanium and Ni-superalloy processing, AM qualification, aerospace supply chains, and facility operations.

RELEVANT WORK

Former Rolls-Royce titanium specialist and Baosteel aerospace-materials executive; research spans powder, AM, forging, inspection, and certification.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Strong industry ties create conflict-screening needs; Australia location adds logistics.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | Aijun.Huang@monash.edu | [public email source](#)

02 David Yan

Associate Professor, San Jose State University Aviation and Technology

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for hybrid additive manufacturing/machining of aerospace alloys, titanium, quality, and process efficiency.

RELEVANT WORK

Publishes on friction-stir processing, high-speed machining, AM, and aerospace-alloy manufacturing.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Academic lab scale may not map directly to acquisition-company operating know-how.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | david.yan@sjsu.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 3-4 for further diligence

03 Jenn-Ming Yang

Distinguished Professor of Materials Science and Engineering, UCLA

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for titanium composites, high-temperature aerospace materials, processing, microstructure, and mechanical behavior.

RELEVANT WORK

Publishes on titanium composites and advanced aerospace structural materials.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Less directly focused on plant operations, deal diligence, or trade-secret identification.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | jyang@seas.ucla.edu | [public email source](#)

04 Scott Thompson

Barton Associate Professor of Mechanical and Aerospace Engineering, University of Missouri

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for metal AM process modeling, defect detection, quality control, and process-structure-property relationships.

RELEVANT WORK

Researches laser powder-bed fusion, directed-energy deposition, defect prevention, and ML for manufacturing.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Additive emphasis may be narrower than conventional forging, machining, and aerospace acquisition operations.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | smthompson@missouri.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 5-6 for further diligence

05 Semih Akin

Assistant Professor of Mechanical, Aerospace and Nuclear Engineering, RPI

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for multiscale AM, surface engineering, smart/in-space manufacturing, repair, and cyber-physical systems.

RELEVANT WORK

Publishes in Additive Manufacturing and Journal of Manufacturing Processes and works on sustainable repair.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Early-career and no titanium/superalloy plant-management experience is established.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | akins@rpi.edu | [public email source](#)

06 Ming C. Leu

Curators' Distinguished Professor, Missouri S&T

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for smart/additive manufacturing, robotics, cyber-physical systems, and aerospace manufacturing centers.

RELEVANT WORK

Founded Missouri S&T's Center for Aerospace Manufacturing Technologies and leads an additive/smart-manufacturing lab.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Broad systems expertise may need a titanium metallurgy specialist as a complement.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | mleu@mst.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 7-8 for further diligence

07 Adam Pilchak

Senior Technical Fellow, Pratt & Whitney; adjunct faculty, Johns Hopkins Engineering

TECHNICAL FIT

Exceptional industry fit for titanium processing, microstructure, fatigue, nondestructive characterization, and engine lifecycle support.

RELEVANT WORK

Internationally recognized titanium dwell-fatigue expert supporting gas-turbine engine programs across the material lifecycle.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Current Pratt & Whitney role presents likely conflict and availability constraints requiring careful clearance.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | apilcha1@jhu.edu | [public email source](#)

08 S. Ehsan Saghaian

Assistant Professor of Mechanical and Civil Engineering, Florida Tech

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for laser powder-bed fusion, Ti/Ni alloys, characterization, finite elements, and aerospace/defense manufacturing.

RELEVANT WORK

Researches composition-process-microstructure-performance relationships in Ti- and Ni-based alloys.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Junior academic; limited evidence of large-scale operating-company or acquisition experience.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | ssaghaian@fit.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 9-10 for further diligence

09 Haijun Gong

Associate Professor of Manufacturing Engineering, Georgia Southern University

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for titanium AM material properties, laser/electron melting, solidification, and process development.

RELEVANT WORK

Research specifically covers titanium alloy AM characterization and simulation.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

The directory visually normalizes the email; confirm the clickable address before any outreach.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | hgong@georgiasouthern.edu | [public email source](#)

10 Yuman Zhu

ARC Future Fellow and Deputy Director, Monash Centre for Additive Manufacturing

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for metal AM, electron microscopy, solidification, phase transformation, and process-property correlation.

RELEVANT WORK

Leads research linking AM process parameters to microstructure and properties.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Australia location and shared institutional relationships with another candidate require conflicts review.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | Yuman.Zhu@monash.edu | [public email source](#)

Preliminary candidates; no conflicts or availability determination

- Run party, affiliate, counsel, inventor, funder, and technology conflicts.
- Confirm testimony history, exclusions, compensation, publications, patents, and deposition performance.
- Investigate licensing, grants, consulting, commercial interests, and prior technical positions.
- Confirm role fit, availability, and interest only after counsel authorizes outreach.

ONGOING MATTER-SPECIFIC RESEARCH

Flint Witness Research works in the post-filing window, turning pleadings and public technical records into issue maps, researched candidate slates, and diligence starting points as the case develops.

[Schedule a 15-minute conversation](#)

CORE SOURCES

Public docket: <https://dockets.justia.com/docket/wyoming/wydce/2%3A2026cv00240/74213>

Official attorney biography and email: <https://wyofile.com/wp-content/uploads/2025/12/University-of-Wyoming-complaint-Dec-2025.pdf>

Public technical context source: <https://www.aiac.com/facilities>

LIMITATIONS

This is a preliminary technical frame based on public sources. Filed pleadings, claim charts, discovery, source code, product versions, and admissible evidence must control.

No attorney or expert was contacted. Availability, interest, compensation, and conflicts were not checked.